PSYC 3233 Exam 1 Topics

Chapter 1

- How do psychologists define development?
    - Difference between growth and biological aging? (slide 3)

- What is the biopsychosocial approach to development? How do lifespan changes fit with this account?

- Be familiar with the cultural differences discussed on slides 7 and 8

- Know the difference between continuity and discontinuity!

- What is the nature-nurture debate? Is one more important for development?

- Know the major developmental theories discussed in this chapter (Evolutionary, Psychoanalytic, Social-cognitive, systems theory, etc.)

- Be familiar with research methods in development (starts on slide 19)

    - What is a theory vs a hypothesis?

    - Scientific method? Know the steps!

    - Sampling/data collection?

    - Difference between a case study, correlation, and experimental design (strengths and weaknesses of each!)

    - Cross-sections vs. longitudinal studies

Chapter 2

- What is natural selection? How is it related to adaptive behavior?

- Be familiar with chromosomes, genes, and DNA (starts on slide 3)

- What is a zygote?

- How many chromosomes are in each human cell? What about sex cells?

- Know the difference between x and y chromosomes. Where can each one be found?

- How are genes inherited? Be familiar with dominant vs. recessive genes
    - What is the difference between genotypes and phenotypes?
- What are the three periods of pregnancy? How long does each period last, and what are the major milestones?
- What are the three layers of the embryo? (slide 19)
- Why are twin studies important? What are some ethical issues with twin studies that we discussed in class?
- Who were the Jim twins? What does their case potentially tell us about the nature-nurture debate?
- What are teratogens (slide 32). Be familiar with the ones discussed in the lecture and be able to identify their effects on prenatal development.
- What is the APGAR test? Be able to list the five areas this test assesses. What do APGAR scores tell us?

Chapter 3

- Know the difference between cephalocaudal and proximodistal patterns of growth
- Be familiar with changes in height/weight during infancy, early childhood, and adolescence.
    - How does the adolescent growth spurt differ between boys and girls?
- What are the costs/benefits of early or late puberty onset? (slide 14)
    - How do these effects differ based on gender?
- Be familiar with theories of aging (slides 15 and 16)